active interest on a very regular basis in the members' work. The hands-off approach trusts team members and recognizes their need for autonomy to carry out their roles, as they see fit. It hinges on their self-motivation. When the leader goes too far with the hands-on approach, he is seen as an anxious and interfering type. If he goes too far hands-off, he is seen as abdicating his responsibility or not being interested. Today, the members of the SLV-3 team have grown to lead some of the country's most prestigious programmes. MSR Dev heads the Augmented Satel ite Launch Vehicle (ASLV) project, Madhavan Nair is the chief of the Polar Satel ite Launch Vehicle (PSLV) project and Sandlas and Sivathanu Pil ai are Chief Control ers in DRDO Headquarters. Each one of these men rose to his present position through consistent hard work and rocklike wil power. It was indeed an exceptional y talented team.

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**Thrusters**

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aving taken up the leadership of executing the SLV-3 project, I faced urgent and conflicting demands on my time